

Readings SF2323, Fall 2025

Module 1: Research questions, research design, and research ethics

Qualitative research questions and design

- Bryman, A. (2016). *Social research methods*. Oxford University Press (chapter 1). Available on Canvas.
- Gerring, J. (2017). “Qualitative methods”. *Annual Review of Political Science*, 20, 15-36.
- Kuckartz, U. (2014). “Analysing qualitative data – but how?” Kuckartz, U. *Qualitative text analysis: A guide to methods, practice & using software* (pp. 1-14). London: SAGE Publications Ltd. Available on Canvas.

Research Ethics

- Wolff-Michael Roth & Hella von Unger (2018). “Current Perspectives on Research Ethics in Qualitative Research”. *Volume Forum Qualitative Research*, 19(3): Art. 33,
url: <https://www.qualitative-research.net/index.php/fqs/article/view/3155/4305> 2.
- Dilmi Aluwihare-Samaranayake (2012). “Ethics in Qualitative Research: A View of the Participants’ and Researchers’ World from a Critical Standpoint”. *International Journal of Qualitative Methods* 11(2):64-81,
url: https://www.researchgate.net/publication/233708898_Ethics_in_Qualitative_Research_A_View_of_the_Participants%27_and_Researchers%27_World_from_a_Critical_Standpoint

Approaches to science

- Fox, N.J. (2008) “Post-positivism”. In: Given, L.M. (ed.) *The SAGE Encyclopaedia of Qualitative Research Methods*. London: Sage. Available on Canvas.
- Hammersley, M. (2019). “From Positivism to Post-Positivism: Progress or Digression?” *Teoria Polityki*, (3), 175-188.

Comparative case study design

- Geddes, Barbara. “How the Cases You Choose Affect the Answers You Get.” *Political Analysis* 2 (1990): 131-149.

- Gerring, John. "The Case Study: What It is and What It Does," in Carles Boix and Susan C. Stokes, eds. *The Oxford Handbook of Comparative Politics*. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2007. Pp. 901-22. Available on Canvas.
- Slater, Dan and Daniel Ziblatt. "The Enduring Indispensability of Controlled Comparison." *Comparative Political Studies* 46.10 (2013): 1301-1327.

Other relevant readings:

- Lieberman, Evan. "Nested Analysis as a Mixed Method Strategy for Comparative Research." *American Political Science Review* 99.3 (2005): 435-52.
- Lijphart, Arend. "The Comparable Cases Strategy in Comparative Research." *Comparative Political Studies* (July 1975): 158-177.
- Seawright, Jason and John Gerring. "Case Selection Techniques in Case Study Research." *Political Research Quarterly* 61.2 (June 2008): 294-308.
- Ziblatt, Daniel. "Of Course Generalize, But How? Returning to Middle Range Theory in Comparative Politics." *American Political Science Association-Comparative Politics Newsletter* 17.2 (2006): 8-11.

Process tracing

- Beach, Derek. 2017. "Process Tracing Methods in Social Science." *Oxford Research Encyclopedia of Politics*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Collier, David. "Understanding Process Tracing." *PS: Political Science and Politics* 44.4 (October 2011): 823-30.
- Tilly, Charles. "To Explain Political Processes." *American Journal of Sociology* (1995): 1594-1610.
- Trampusch, Christine, and Palier, Bruno. 2017. Between X and Y: How Process Tracing Contributes to Opening the Black Box of Causality, *New Political Economy*, 21 (5): 437-454.

Module 2: Data collection, analysis, and interpretation

Interviews

- Magnusson, Eva and Jeanne Marecek (2015): *Doing Interview-based Qualitative Research: A Learner's Guide*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press. Available on GUNDA. Chapters 1, 3-8, and 12
- Lilleker, D. G. (2003). "Interviewing the Political Elite: Navigating a Potential Minefield". *Politics*, 23(3), 207-214. <https://doi.org/10.1111/1467-9256.00198>

Observations

- Miller, C. (2022). "'Ethno, Ethno, What?': Using Ethnography to Explore the European Parliament's Political Groups in Turbulent Times". In *European Parliament's Political Groups in Turbulent Times* (pp. 245-266). Cham: Springer International Publishing.
- Berthet, V., Gaweda, B., Kantola, J., Miller, C., Ahrens, P., & Elomäki, A. (2023). *Guide to Qualitative Research in Parliaments: Experiences and Practices*. Palgrave Macmillan

Typology analysis

- Aronovitch, H. (2012). "Interpreting Weber's ideal-types". *Philosophy of the Social Sciences*, 42(3), 356-369.
- Collier, David, Jody LaPorte, and Jason Seawright. (2008). "Typologies: Forming Concepts and Creating Categorical Variables". In Janet Box-Steffensmeier, Henry E. Brady, and David Collier, eds., *The Oxford Handbook of Political Methodology*. New York: Oxford University Press. Pdf available on Canvas.
- Friberg-Fernros (2023). "Addressing the Ideational Turn: How the Resources of Qualitative Content Analysis and Idea Analysis Can Together Strengthen the Study of Ideas". Under review. Available on Canvas.

Discourse analysis

- Jørgensen and Phillips, 2002, Ch 2: "Laclau and Mouffe's Discourse Theory" in *Discourse Analysis as Theory and Method*. New York: Sage. Available on Canvas.
- Neumann, I. 2008. "Discourse Analysis" in Klotz and Prakash (eds.), *Qualitative Methods in International Relations: A Pluralist Guide*. Basingstoke: Palgrave. Available on Canvas.

- Holzberg, B., Kolbe, K., & Zaborowski, R. (2018). "Figures of Crisis: The Delineation of (Un)Deserving Refugees in the German Media". *Sociology*, 52(3), 534–550. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0038038518759460>
- Said, E. 'Introduction' (pp. 1-16) in *Orientalism*. Pdf available on canvas.